

Patient Guide

Everything you need to know before your first visit to Bright Smile Dental

Document BSD-PG | Version 3.2 | Effective 1 September 2026

Sample content: Bright Smile Dental is a fictional practice. This document was written for a software demonstration and is not medical advice.

Welcome to Bright Smile Dental

Bright Smile Dental is an independent private dental practice at 12 High Street, London W1A 1AA. The practice has been led by Dr Sarah Whitfield since 2014 and looks after patients of all ages, from a child's very first check-up to complex implant and root canal treatment.

This Patient Guide explains how Bright Smile Dental works: how to register, what happens at your first visit, how to reach the practice, and what support is available if you are nervous or have access needs. Separate documents cover appointment and payment rules, individual treatments, aftercare, and dental emergencies.

Contacting Bright Smile Dental

You can contact Bright Smile Dental in three ways:

- By phone on +44 20 7946 0123 during opening hours.
- By email at hello@brightsmile.example. Emails are answered within one working day. Do not use email for urgent problems.
- Through the chat assistant on the Bright Smile Dental website, which can answer questions and book, move or cancel appointments at any time of day.

The chat assistant cannot give a diagnosis or clinical advice. If you describe a problem that sounds urgent, it will give you the practice phone number and the emergency guidance in this guide.

Opening hours

Bright Smile Dental is open Monday to Friday, 9:00am to 5:00pm. The practice is closed on Saturdays, Sundays and UK bank holidays. The last appointment of the day starts at 4:30pm.

Outside opening hours the phone line plays a recorded message with emergency guidance. For an urgent dental problem when the practice is closed, call NHS 111. For a life-threatening emergency, such as swelling that makes it hard to breathe or swallow, call 999.

Our dental team

Bright Smile Dental has three dentists and a hygiene team. Each dentist sees general patients and also has an area of special interest:

Dentist	Qualifications	Special interest
Dr Sarah Whitfield	BDS, MJDF RCS	General and cosmetic dentistry, nervous patients
Dr Omar Haddad	BDS, MSc Endodontics	Root canal treatment, including complex cases
Dr Mei Tanaka	BDS, MSc Oral Surgery	Dental implants and surgical extractions

You can ask to see a particular dentist when you book. If you have no preference, Bright Smile Dental will offer you the earliest available appointment with any dentist who provides the treatment you need.

Registering as a new patient

New patients can register by booking their first appointment. There is no separate registration form to complete in advance and no joining fee.

To register at Bright Smile Dental you will need to give:

- Your full name.
- A mobile phone number. Bright Smile Dental uses this number to find your appointments, so please use the same number every time you book.
- An email address, if you would like appointment confirmations by email. This is optional.

Children under 16 should be registered by a parent or guardian, and a parent or guardian must attend their appointments.

Your first visit

Your first visit to Bright Smile Dental is normally a check-up and clean, which lasts 30 minutes. Please arrive ten minutes early so there is time to complete your medical history.

At a first check-up, the dentist will:

1. Ask about any problems or concerns you have with your teeth or gums.
2. Go through your medical history and any medicines you take.
3. Examine your teeth, gums, tongue, cheeks and the soft tissues of your mouth.
4. Take X-rays if they are needed. X-rays are not taken at every visit.
5. Clean and polish your teeth, removing plaque and tartar.
6. Explain anything they have found and, if treatment is needed, give you a written treatment plan with the options and costs before anything is done.

No treatment beyond the check-up and clean is carried out at a first visit unless you agree to it after it has been explained.

What to bring to your appointment

Please bring:

- A list of any medicines you take, including inhalers, blood thinners and anything bought without a prescription.
- Details of any allergies, especially to latex, antibiotics or local anaesthetic.
- Your glasses, if you need them to read forms.
- Your dental insurance details, if you have a policy and want an itemised receipt for a claim.

Your medical history

Your medical history matters even for routine dental care. Some conditions and medicines change how dental treatment is carried out. For example, blood-thinning medicines can increase bleeding after an extraction, and some medicines for bone conditions affect how the jaw heals after surgery.

At every visit you will be asked whether anything has changed. Please always tell Bright Smile Dental if you have started or stopped a medicine, have been diagnosed with a new condition, or are pregnant. Your medical history is kept confidential and is only seen by the clinical team.

If you are nervous about the dentist

Many patients feel anxious about dental treatment, and Bright Smile Dental is used to helping nervous patients. Dr Sarah Whitfield has a particular interest in caring for nervous patients.

If you are nervous, it helps to tell the practice when you book. Things that can help nervous patients include:

- A longer first appointment, so nothing feels rushed.
- Agreeing a stop signal, such as raising your hand, so you can pause treatment at any time.
- Having the dentist explain each step before doing it.
- Bringing headphones to listen to music during treatment.
- Booking the first appointment of the morning, so there is less time to worry during the day.

Bright Smile Dental does not offer sedation at the practice. If you feel you need sedation, the dentist can discuss a referral to a service that provides it.

Children at Bright Smile Dental

Bright Smile Dental sees children of all ages. A child's first visit is kept short and relaxed so that they can get used to the practice, the chair and the dentist before any treatment is ever needed.

Children can usually start visiting once their first teeth appear, and it is helpful to bring a child along to a parent's check-up first so the practice feels familiar. A parent or guardian must stay with children under 16 throughout their appointment.

Teeth whitening is not offered to patients under 18.

Accessibility

Bright Smile Dental has step-free access from the street and a ground-floor surgery, so patients who use wheelchairs or have limited mobility can be seen without using stairs. There is an accessible toilet on the ground floor.

If you have access needs, please mention them when you book, for example if you need extra time, a quieter appointment, or help transferring to the dental chair. Assistance dogs are welcome.

Getting to the practice

Bright Smile Dental is at 12 High Street, London W1A 1AA, about a five-minute walk from the station.

There is paid street parking directly outside the practice and a public car park behind the library.

Bright Smile Dental does not have its own car park. If you are driving, please allow extra time to find a space, especially in the morning.

Feedback and complaints

Bright Smile Dental welcomes feedback, good or bad. If you are unhappy with any part of your care, please tell the dentist or the practice team so it can be put right quickly. The full complaints procedure is set out in the Insurance, Privacy and Practice Policies document.